

Horror Movie Archive — UX Specification

1. Design Principles

Core Experience Goals

- premium curated horror archive feel
- atmospheric, cinematic presentation
- never gimmicky or cliché horror UI
- zero-friction core workflows
- content-first interface
- desktop-first experience
- consistency across all screens

Visual Philosophy

Reference mood:

- Criterion archive meets premium horror collector app

Avoid:

- corporate SaaS dashboard aesthetics
- spreadsheet clone feel
- excessive horror tropes
- flashy or noisy animation

Motion Philosophy

Allowed:

- subtle hover polish
- smooth transitions
- restrained atmospheric effects
- premium shimmer for masterpiece states

Avoid:

- aggressive animations
 - distracting motion
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2. App Shell

Navigation Architecture

Hybrid desktop application shell.

Sidebar

Left navigation sidebar.

Sections:

- Library
- Dashboard
- Year in Review
- Lists
- Settings

Behavior:

- collapsible (Notion-style)
- collapse to icon rail
- content expands automatically when collapsed
- collapsed state persists between sessions

Visual direction:

- dark matte surface
- subtle grain/texture
- restrained gradients
- premium typography
- atmospheric but understated

Sidebar also displays total movie count.

Top Utility Bar

Library top bar pattern:

- page title
- utility controls

Example: Horror Movie List    [+ Add Movie]

Behavior:

- sticky
- always visible while scrolling

3. Library UX

Default Mode

Primary default view: List View

Secondary: Grid View

List View

Primary management experience.

Characteristics:

- comfortable row density
- centered content
- wrapped text instead of aggressive truncation
- soft max wrapping for extreme long values
- subtle row hover state
- full row click opens movie details modal

Sticky Behavior

Sticky:

- utility bar
- column headers

Not sticky:

- data columns

Sorting

Excel-style header sorting.

Supported:

- ascending / descending per sortable column

Default Columns

Default visual model includes:

- poster
- year

- title
- PT title
- director
- country
- distributor
- badge
- stars
- personal review
- IMDb
- Rotten Tomatoes

Columns remain customizable.

Search

Search icon expands inline search field in toolbar.

Behavior:

- simple matching result display
- no match highlighting required

Filters

Icon-triggered filter experience.

Not permanently visible.

Pagination

100 movies per page.

Grid View

Secondary browsing experience.

Card Structure

- authentic poster ratio
- display title
- Best of Year crown near year
- stars
- IMDb
- badge

Interactions

Hover:

- slight lift
- subtle zoom
- restrained atmospheric glow

Click: full card opens movie details modal

Special States

10/10:

- gold title shimmer

Best of Year:

- subtle outlined crown near year

Missing poster:

- clean placeholder
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4. Add Movie UX

Entry

Triggered by + Add Movie button.

Container

Right-side slide panel.

Characteristics:

- medium width
- library remains visible behind dimmed overlay

Search State

Structure:

- panel title
- close button
- search field

- compact live search results

Behavior:

- real-time search
- debounce behavior
- strongest matches prioritized first
- explicit click selection (no enter auto-select)

Confirmation State

Same panel morphs into confirmation layout.

Includes:

- poster
- display title
- original title
- PT title
- year
- director
- runtime
- review dropdown
- watched date (optional)
- Best of Year checkbox
- save
- back

Duplicate UX

Inline warning.

No disruptive modal.

No Match UX

Simple fallback: Add Manually

Success State

Post-save confirmation:

- Add Another
 - View Movie
-

5. Movie Details UX

Container

Large near-fullscreen modal overlay.

Behavior:

- preserves prior browsing context
- closes back to exact prior state
- ESC closes modal

Layout

Two-column cinematic layout.

Left Column

Large hero poster.

If VHS theme active: poster shown in VHS mockup.

Action:

- Change Poster

Right Column

Hero information block:

- display title
- original title
- PT title (secondary styling)
- Best of Year crown
- review score
- stars
- IMDb
- Rotten Tomatoes
- badge

10/10 state: premium gold treatment.

Metadata Section

Two-column clean metadata grid.

Synopsis

Visible by default.

Cast / Crew

Expandable sections.

Lists

Inline chips + Manage Lists action.

Actions

Top-right:

- Edit
- Refresh Metadata
- Delete

Edit Mode

Same modal transforms into edit state.

Grouped editing:

- basic metadata
- personal data
- advanced overrides

Refresh Metadata UX

Comparison experience.

Behavior:

- current vs new values
- field-level overwrite control

Safety

Unsaved changes warning on close.

6. Dashboard UX

Style

Hybrid dashboard structure with editorial archive presentation.

Layout

Single long vertical page.

Sections

- hero metrics row
- distributions
- rankings
- Best of Year showcase
- 10/10 masterpieces showcase
- recent activity (conditional)
- fun stats

Charts

Readable cinematic styling.

Restrained presentation.

Not generic BI dashboard visuals.

7. Year in Review UX

Style

Editorial storytelling retrospective.

Layout

Single immersive annual report page.

Structure

- year selector
- hero annual summary
- Best of Year spotlight
- 10/10 showcase
- monthly watch timeline

- curated stats
- worst surprise / lowest rated

Empty State

No watches recorded state.

8. Lists UX

Lists Landing

Card-based browser.

Top bar:

- title
- search
- create list

List cards include:

- list name
- movie count
- optional description

Create List

Simple modal.

Fields:

- name
- description

List Detail

Reuses Library UX shell.

Supports:

- list/grid
- search
- filters
- sorting

Manual Ordering

Only in list view.

Drag handle ordering.

9. Settings UX

Structure

Sidebar-style settings navigation.

Sections:

- Appearance
- Security
- Backup & Restore
- Preferences

Appearance

Theme preview cards:

- Horror Archive
- VHS
- Minimal

Security

- change PIN
- trusted device reset
- recovery/reset path

Backup & Restore

- CSV export
- JSON export
- merge restore
- replace-all restore

Preferences

- reset layout preferences
 - reset app preferences
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10. Theming

Built-in Themes

- Horror Archive
- VHS
- Minimal

Theme Rules

Themes affect presentation only.

Semantics remain unchanged.

VHS Rules

Poster mockup applies in:

- grid
- movie details

Poster picker remains clean.

11. Interaction Rules

Core Rules

- preserve user context whenever possible
- avoid navigation disruption
- prioritize direct manipulation
- keep destructive actions explicit

Loading Rules

Interfaces should feel responsive and premium.

Empty States

Must feel intentional, not broken.

Error States

Graceful and non-blocking where possible.